The Helper Lever

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 11

Two levers had similar handles. Nib reached for the bigger one, which looked impressively helpful. The guide's small connecting line led to the other lever. Lark kept the mechanism unloaded while the keeper showed where that smaller control met the reset linkage.

“The biggest helper,” Nib announced. “The helper with this job,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **planting**

“Er can name someone or something that does a job,” Lark explained clearly. “Help plus er makes helper; sing plus er makes singer. Read the parts, rejoin them, then ask what job the whole word describes in this sentence.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try helper, singer, player. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read helper in the prepared diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual lever has the reset job?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The helper can lift the arm. The player can sing.**

“Which subject can lift the arm?” Lark asked gently. “Read the job described in each sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

With the keeper, Nib tested the small lever's unloaded movement. The linkage responded where the diagram predicted. They did not reset the live cycle yet: the guide asked for a water-and-light check first. The correct control was found, and its proper moment still needed observing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helper beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal connected the small lever to its actual work. Bigger handles no longer looked like better evidence. Outside, sunlight on the gauge and dampness on the guide created two practical problems for the next reading.